## READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

# Risk taking

**A** We run risks. Most of the time we ignore them; sometimes we stop and decide how to deal with them. That's life. Risks arise in sports, in business, in personal relationships; they are present in the laboratory, in political calculations, everywhere. Acting individually, we often prefer to gain some benefit by accepting some danger. Acting collectively, we make similar trade-offs.

**B** When society must assess risks, and those risks can be clarified, at least in part, by science, technology or mathematics, the responsibility of the research community is to be clear and complete. But that is not always so easy. Furthermore, too few people pay full attention to the best evidence, much less modify their behaviors as a result. Even when the evidence of high risk is clear – about smoking, for instance – many will deny the risk, or dispute it, or accept that it exists and still go ahead. As a former cigarette smoker, I understand denial.

**C** Perhaps more important than the basic facts of risk are the varied perception of it. Hearing the prediction of 60% chance of rain, or recognizing the minuscule likelihood of becoming ill from a flu shot, most people understand the right responses: take your umbrella and get your flu shot. But some, fearfully but irrationally, go to the extreme and stay at home and avoid all contact with other people. Irrational decisions occasionally affect us all. When it comes to risks the best odds do not always influence people to make the correct decision.

**D** In her book, *The Universe and the Teacup*, the science writer K. C. Cole reminds us that the risks of losing something and gaining something appear to be calculated in our minds according to quite different scales. People will risk a lot to prevent a loss, she notes; some people will rush into a burning building to save a pet. But they will usually risk very little if the only perceived outcome is a possible gain; many people won't even risk pursuing an exciting job, if the current job, though unfulfilling, remains comfortable. That psychological mechanism, a desire to maintain the status quo, helps explain the high hurdles that any rational risk assessment must confront.

**E** Organizations face the same hurdles whenever they must cope with major shifts in policy. In his classic examination of the character of high-tech industry, *Only the Paranoid Survive*, Andrew S. Grove gives a perceptive account of a crisis that took place during his tenure as Chairman of the Intel Corporation. The business environment for Intel and its competitors was transformed by a flood of low-cost memory chips from Japan, and Intel made the difficult decision to abandon its chip-

making business. Such a period of change in the outside world is filled with danger, Grove notes, precisely because it is so easy for executives to try to disregard it or misinterpret the mounting evidence showing the profound risks of not making change at the very core. The distinction Cole cites is instructive here: one reason management and staff may not act is that they tend to focus on the potential gains of risking change (which they characterize as small), rather than on the catastrophic losses that risking change could prevent. The period becomes critical for a company, according to Grove, and deadly when unattended to.

**F** Likewise, at the national level, and even the global one, institutions tend to be more willing to take a risk if it means avoiding a loss, than they are if it might confer a gain. Almost everyone, for instance, sees the signs of ecological decay. Reid J. Lifset's article, 'Full Accounting', describes newly developed techniques for clarifying which critical decision would have the highest pay-offs for the environment. Once these 'leverage points' as he calls them, are located, many environmental organizations will be willing to risk the resources needed to prevent further deterioration.

**G** More complicated are decisions by nations to invest broadly in educational research. Some governmental leaders are oblivious to the risks posed by social under-investment, because the urgent needs of the present take precedence over actions that would give rise to even more substantial gains in the future. Their attitude is that today's risks must be manageable, and that tomorrow's gains are at the very least difficult to measure. Better consideration and decision making for what lies ahead is essential.

**H** Nevertheless, I confess to being an optimist. My glass is generally half full – though that may not help me handle risk. Whether one's temperament is optimistic or pessimistic, everyone in our scientific and engineering community has a social responsibility: measure with care and portray with honesty the level of risk involved in any action or decision.

*Questions 27–30*

*Complete each sentence with the correct ending,* ***A–G****, below.*

*Write the correct letter,* ***A–G****, in boxes 27–30 on your answer sheet.*

**27** K. C. Cole points out that avoiding a loss seems more important to people than

**28** According to Andrew S. Grove, it can be very dangerous for companies to ignore

**29** Reid J. Lifset argues that environmental agencies can benefit from

**30** The writer suggests that government leaders need to focus more on

| | |
|---|---|
| **A** | planning for the future. |
| **B** | predicting their errors. |
| **C** | continuing in the present situation. |
| **D** | recent findings on the most effective solutions to problems. |
| **E** | achieving a gain. |
| **F** | changes occurring externally. |
| **G** | a high level of agreement. |

*Questions 31–39*

*Reading Passage 3 has eight paragraphs,* ***A–H****.*

*Which paragraph contains the following information?*

*Write the correct letter,* ***A–H****, in boxes 31–39 on your answer sheet.*

***NB*** *You may use any letter more than once.*

**31** the areas of study that help us understand risk

**32** reference to key actions that might benefit the world

**33** examples of statistical predictions that the majority of the public react to in the same way

**34** the variety of contexts in which risk occurs

**35** mention of a habit that has been proved to be very risky

**36** reference to market forces motivating change

**37** the writer's current attitude towards risk

**38** a reason why some individuals avoid making a career change

**39** how some people over-react to information about risk

*Question 40*

*Choose the correct letter,* ***A****,* ***B****,* ***C*** *or* ***D****.*

*Write the correct letter in box 40 on your answer sheet.*

At the end of the passage the writer concludes that

**A** risk is something we must try to avoid.
**B** experts should be truthful about risk to the public.
**C** optimists are better able to deal with risk than pessimists.
**D** it is important to take risks in order to fulfil social obligations.

## 第一部分：27–30（Sentence Completion 句子补全）

| 题号 | 答案 | 题干翻译 | 出题句（段落＋完整定位句） | 出题句翻译（全面） | 详细解释（更细） |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 27 | E | K. C. Cole 指出：对人们而言，避免损失似乎比___更重要。 | D段：In her book, The Universe and the Teacup, the science writer K. C. Cole reminds us that the risks of losing something and gaining something appear to be calculated in our minds according to quite different scales. People will risk a lot to prevent a loss, she notes; some people will rush into a burning building to save a pet. But they will usually risk very little if the only perceived outcome is a possible gain. | 在她的书《宇宙与茶杯》中，科普作家 K. C. Cole 提醒我们：在我们的大脑里，“失去某物的风险”和“获得某物的风险”似乎是用两套完全不同的尺度来计算的。她指出，人们为了避免损失会愿意冒很大的风险；有人甚至会冲进着火的建筑去救宠物。但如果他们认为结果只是“可能获得收益”，他们通常只愿意冒非常小的风险。 | 题干结构是 A is more important than B：避免损失比什么更重要。原文的核心对比是 prevent a loss（避免损失）vs possible gain（可能获得收益）。作者先举“冲进火场救宠物”说明为避免损失会冒大险，再用转折句 But…possible gain 说明如果只是为了可能的收益，人们反而几乎不愿冒险。也就是说，在心理权重上，loss 的分量大于 gain。答案 E 对应 gaining something/achieving a gain（获得收益）。 |
| 28 | F | 根据 Andrew S. Grove 的说法，公司忽视___会非常危险。 | E段：Such a period of change in the outside world is filled with danger, Grove notes, precisely because it is so easy for executives to try to disregard it or misinterpret the mounting evidence showing the profound risks of not making change at the very core. The period becomes critical for a company, according to Grove, and deadly when unattended to. | Grove 指出：外部世界发生变化的这种时期充满危险。原因恰恰在于，高层管理者太容易试图忽视这种变化，或者误读不断累积的证据，而这些证据显示：如果不在公司最核心处做出改变，将会带来极其深重的风险。Grove 认为，这一时期对公司而言会变得至关重要；如果被放任不管（无人处理/无人关注），甚至会致命。 | 题干关键词 ignore（忽视）。定位句明确点出忽视的对象是 period of change in the outside world（外部世界的变化时期）。危险来自：外部环境变了，但管理层要么 disregard（无视），要么 misinterpret（误读）证据，导致不在核心做改变，风险累积到“deadly”。因此“非常危险”对应的就是忽视外部变化/外部发生的变化（F）。注意：这里不是“忽视内部问题”，而是明确 outside world；也不是“忽视风险本身”，而是忽视外部变化及其证据。 |
| 29 | D | Reid J. Lifset 认为：环保机构可以从___中获益。 | F段：Reid J. Lifset’s article, Full Accounting, describes newly developed techniques for clarifying which critical decision would have the highest pay-offs for the environment. Once these leverage points as he calls them, are located, many environmental organizations will be willing to risk the resources needed to prevent further deterioration. | Reid J. Lifset 的文章《全面核算》描述了一些新近开发的技术，这些技术可以帮助澄清：哪些关键决策会为环境带来最高的回报。一旦找到这些他称之为“杠杆点”的关键位置，许多环保组织就愿意冒险投入所需资源，以防止环境进一步恶化。 | 题干问 benefit from（从…获益）。原文的“获益点”是 newly developed techniques（新开发的技术）带来的能力：clarifying which critical decision would have the highest pay-offs（弄清楚哪个关键决策回报最高）。环保机构因此能更精准地找到 leverage points（最有效的着力点），从而更愿意投入资源。对应选项 D 的逻辑应是“近期研究/新方法告诉我们最有效的解决方案/着力点”，而不是“资金更多”“人更勇敢”这类无依据内容。关键词链：newly developed techniques → clarifying → highest pay-offs → leverage points。 |
| 30 | A | 作者认为：政府领导人需要更多关注___。 | G段：Some governmental leaders are oblivious to the risks posed by social under-investment, because the urgent needs of the present take precedence over actions that would give rise to even more substantial gains in the future. Their attitude is that today’s risks must be manageable, and that tomorrow’s gains are at the very least difficult to measure. Better consideration and decision making for what lies ahead is essential. | 一些政府领导人对“社会投入不足所带来的风险”视而不见，因为当下紧迫需求压倒了那些能够在未来带来更巨大收益的行动。他们的态度是：今天的风险必须是可控/可管理的；而明天的收益至少很难衡量。因此，对未来将会发生什么进行更好的考量与决策，是必不可少的。 | 题干 focus more on（更关注）。原文反复对照 present vs future：他们让 urgent needs of the present（当下需求）优先，忽略 future gains（未来收益）与 long-term risks（长期风险）；作者最后一句点题：Better consideration and decision making for what lies ahead（对未来作更好决策）。所以应选 A planning for the future（为未来做规划/关注未来）。这里不是让政府更“冒险”，而是让他们把时间维度拉长：别只看今天能否管理，必须把未来的收益与风险纳入决策。 |

## 第二部分：31–39（Matching Information 段落匹配 A–H）

| 题号 | 答案 | 题干翻译 | 出题句（段落＋完整定位句） | 出题句翻译（全面） | 详细解释（更细） |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 31 | B | 哪一段提到：帮助我们理解风险的研究领域？ | B段：When society must assess risks, and those risks can be clarified, at least in part, by science, technology or mathematics, the responsibility of the research community is to be clear and complete. | 当社会必须评估风险，并且这些风险至少可以在一定程度上借助科学、技术或数学得到澄清时，研究群体的责任就是把信息说清楚、说完整。 | 题干问 areas of study（研究领域）。定位句直接列出 science, technology, mathematics，这就是“学科范围”。后半句谈 research community 的责任，是围绕这些学科能澄清风险这一前提展开。 |
| 32 | F | 哪一段提到：可能使世界受益的关键行动？ | F段：Reid J. Lifset's article, Full Accounting, describes newly developed techniques for clarifying which critical decision would have the highest pay-offs for the environment. Once these leverage points as he calls them, are located, many environmental organizations will be willing to risk the resources needed to prevent further deterioration. | Lifset 的文章描述新技术，用来弄清哪些关键决策对环境回报最高。一旦找到这些“杠杆点”，环保组织就愿意投入资源以阻止进一步恶化。 | 题干的 key actions 指“关键行动/关键决策”。原文用 critical decision（关键决策）+ leverage points（杠杆点）精确表达“做什么最有效、回报最大”，而“benefit the world”在文中体现为 for the environment、prevent deterioration（阻止环境恶化）。所以锁定 F。 |
| 33 | C | 统计预测的例子：多数公众反应一致 | C段：Hearing the prediction of 60% chance of rain, or recognizing the minuscule likelihood of becoming ill from a flu shot, most people understand the right responses: take your umbrella and get your flu shot. | 听到“有 60% 的概率下雨”的预测，或者意识到“因为打流感疫苗而生病”的概率极其微小，大多数人都知道正确反应：带伞、去打疫苗。 | 题干要 examples of statistical predictions（统计预测例子）+ majority react the same way（大多数人反应一致）。句中两个概率例子：60% chance、minuscule likelihood，并明确 most people understand the right responses。完全对应。 |
| 34 | A | 风险出现的多种情境 | A段：Risks arise in sports, in business, in personal relationships; they are present in the laboratory, in political calculations, everywhere. Acting individually, we often prefer to gain some benefit by accepting some danger. Acting collectively, we make similar trade-offs. | 风险出现在体育、商业、人际关系中；也存在于实验室、政治算计里——无处不在。就个人而言，我们常常愿意通过接受一定危险来换取某种收益；集体行动时，我们也会做类似的权衡取舍。 | 题干的 variety of contexts（多种情境）在这一句用并列列举完成：sports/business/relationships/laboratory/political/everywhere。后两句补充“个人与集体都在做风险—收益权衡”，进一步强化“情境广泛”。 |
| 35 | B | 提到一种已被证明非常危险的习惯 | B段：Even when the evidence of high risk is clear – about smoking, for instance – many will deny the risk, or dispute it, or accept that it exists and still go ahead. As a former cigarette smoker, I understand denial. | 即使高风险的证据已经很清楚——例如吸烟——许多人仍会否认风险、质疑风险，或即便承认它存在也照做不误。作为曾经的吸烟者，我理解这种否认心理。 | 题干关键词 habit（习惯）+ proved very risky（已被证明高风险）。smoking 是典型习惯；并且作者说 evidence of high risk is clear，说明风险证据确凿。后面讲 deny/dispute/accept but still go ahead，是在解释人们为何仍继续高风险习惯。 |
| 36 | E | 提到市场力量推动改变 | E段：The business environment for Intel and its competitors was transformed by a flood of low-cost memory chips from Japan, and Intel made the difficult decision to abandon its chip-making business. | 英特尔及其竞争对手所处的商业环境，被来自日本的大量低价存储芯片的涌入彻底改变；英特尔因此做出艰难决定：放弃其存储芯片业务。 | market forces（市场力量）在这里体现为外部竞争冲击：low-cost chips flood in → business environment transformed → forced strategic change（放弃业务）。这不是内部自发改革，而是由市场竞争压力驱动。 |
| 37 | H | 作者当前对风险的态度 | H段：Nevertheless, I confess to being an optimist. My glass is generally half full – though that may not help me handle risk. | 尽管如此，我承认自己是个乐观主义者。我的杯子通常被我看作半满——不过这也未必能帮助我更好地应对风险。 | 题干问 writer's current attitude。作者直接自我陈述 optimist、glass half full，这是对自身气质/态度的明确定位；后半句补充“乐观未必更会处理风险”，避免读者误以为作者要推崇乐观。 |
| 38 | D | 解释为什么一些人会避免职业变动 | D段：But they will usually risk very little if the only perceived outcome is a possible gain; many people won't even risk pursuing an exciting job, if the current job, though unfulfilling, remains comfortable. That psychological mechanism, a desire to maintain the status quo, helps explain the high hurdles that any rational risk assessment must confront. | 但如果他们认为结果只是“可能获得收益”，他们通常只愿意冒很小的风险；许多人甚至不会冒险去追求一份令人兴奋的工作，只要目前的工作虽然并不令人满足，却依然舒适。这种心理机制——维持现状的欲望——有助于解释：任何理性的风险评估都会遭遇很高的心理门槛。 | 题干是“原因”。原文把“职业不变动”解释为：当前工作 comfortable（舒适）→ 即便 unfulfilling（不满足）也不愿冒险换成 exciting job（更令人兴奋的工作）。根因点明为 desire to maintain the status quo（维持现状偏好）。这是典型的“现状偏差”：人们把潜在收益看得小，却把改变的不确定性放大。 |
| 39 | C | 有人如何对风险信息反应过度 | C段：But some, fearfully but irrationally, go to the extreme and stay at home and avoid all contact with other people. Irrational decisions occasionally affect us all. When it comes to risks the best odds do not always influence people to make the correct decision. | 但有些人出于恐惧却不理性，会走向极端：待在家里，避免与任何人接触。非理性的决定有时会影响到我们所有人。谈到风险时，即便胜算最好，也不一定能让人做出正确决定。 | over-react 的同义线索就是 go to the extreme（走向极端）。前文本来在讲“多数人对概率信息反应合理”，这里用 But some… 形成对照：少数人被恐惧驱动，采取极端行为。后两句总结“非理性会影响所有人”“赔率并不总能驱动正确决策”，进一步解释为什么这是过度反应而非理性防护。 |

**第三部分：40（Multiple Choice 主旨 / 结论题）**

| 题号 | 答案 | 题干翻译 | 出题句（段落＋完整定位句） | 出题句翻译（全面） | 详细解释（更细） |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 40 | B | 文章结尾作者得出的结论是： | H段：Whether one's temperament is optimistic or pessimistic, everyone in our scientific and engineering community has a social responsibility: measure with care and portray with honesty the level of risk involved in any action or decision. | 无论一个人的性格气质是乐观还是悲观，我们科学与工程领域的每一个人都承担着一种社会责任：对任何行动或决策所涉及的风险水平，都要谨慎衡量，并诚实呈现。 | 结尾的逻辑重心不在“要不要冒险”，而在“如何对社会呈现风险”。作者先排除无关变量：optimistic or pessimistic 都一样（不管你性格如何），然后给出结论：scientific and engineering community has a social responsibility。责任的具体内容是 measure with care（谨慎测量/评估）+ portray with honesty（如实呈现/诚实表达）风险水平。这与选项 B experts should be truthful about risk to the public 完全同义（honesty/portray = truthful）。A 说要避免风险，文中并未主张“避免”，而是主张“准确、诚实地评估并传达”；C 说乐观更会应对风险，作者反而说乐观未必帮助处理风险；D 说为履行社会义务就要冒险，文末说的是“社会责任在于诚实呈现风险”，不是“必须去冒险”。 |

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